Overview of OnCommand Workflow Automation

OnCommand Workflow Automation 5.1

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Table of Contents

Overview of OnCommand Workflow Automation . . . 1
WFA features . . . 1
WFA license information . . . 1
OnCommand Workflow Automation deployment architecture . . . 2
OnCommand Workflow Automation installation and setup overview . . . 2
Known limitations and enhancements . . . 3

Overview of OnCommand Workflow Automation

OnCommand Workflow Automation (WFA) is a software solution that helps to automate storage management tasks, such as provisioning, migration, decommissioning, data protection configurations, and cloning storage. You can use WFA to build workflows to complete tasks that are specified by your processes. WFA supports both ONTAP and Data ONTAP operating in 7-Mode.

A workflow is a repetitive and procedural task that consists of sequential steps, including the following types of tasks:

- Provisioning, migrating, or decommissioning storage for databases or file systems
- Setting up a new virtualization environment, including storage switches and datastores
- Setting up storage for an application as part of an end-to-end orchestration process

Storage architects can define workflows to follow best practices and meet organizational requirements, such as the following:

- Using required naming conventions
- Setting unique options for storage objects
- Selecting resources
- Integrating internal configuration management database (CMDB) and ticketing applications

WFA features

- Workflow design portal to build workflows

  The workflow design portal includes several building blocks, such as commands, templates, finders, filters, and functions, that are used to create workflows. The designer enables you to include advanced capabilities to workflows such as automated resource selection, row repetition (looping), and approval points.

  The workflow design portal also includes building blocks, such as dictionary entries, cache queries, and data source types, for caching data from external systems.

- Execution portal to execute workflows, verify status of workflow execution, and access logs
- Administration/Settings option for tasks such as setting up WFA, connecting to data sources, and configuring user credentials
- Web service interfaces to invoke workflows from external portals and data center orchestration software
- Storage Automation Store to download WFA packs. The ONTAP 9.7.0 pack is bundled with WFA 5.1.

WFA license information

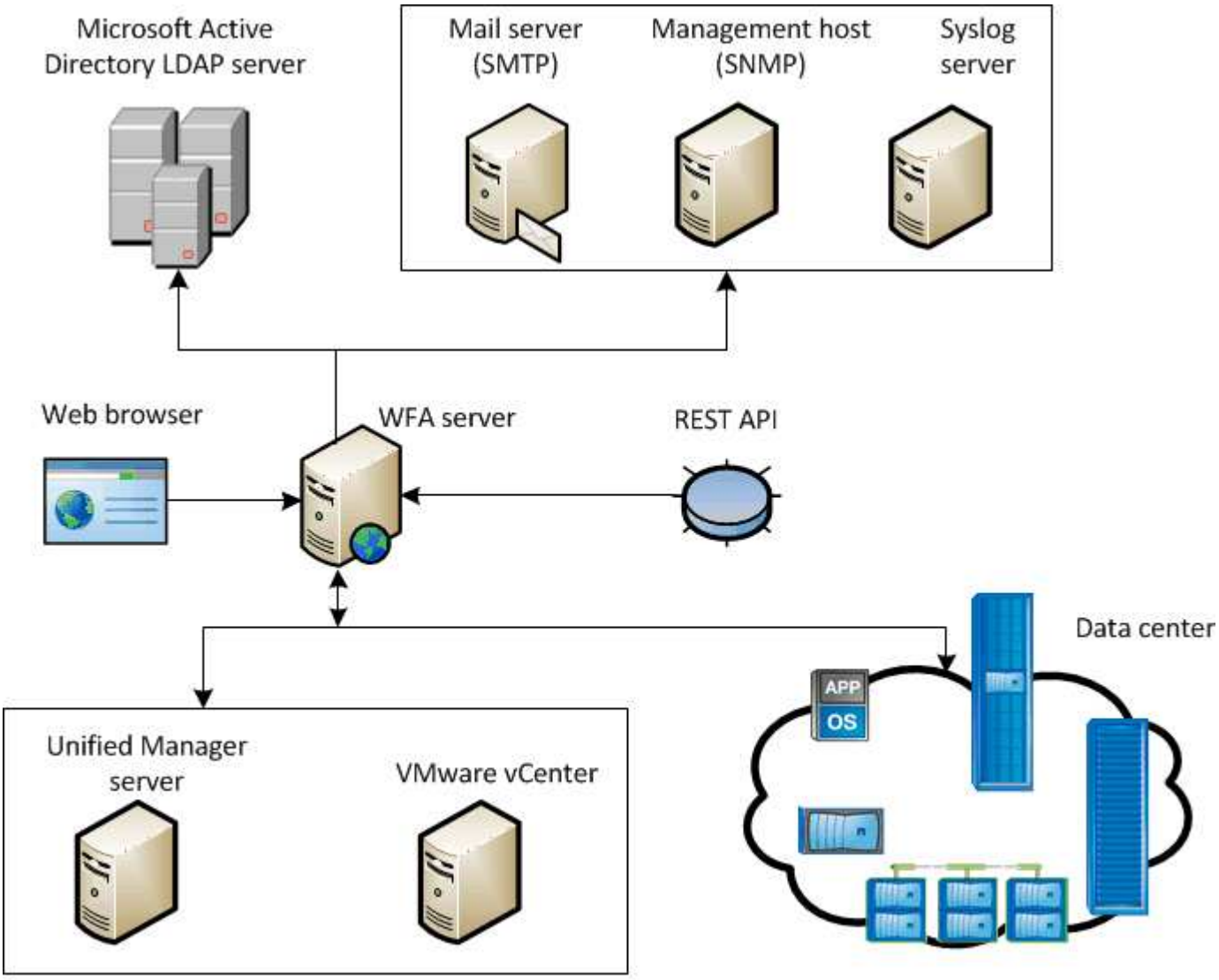
No license is required for using the OnCommand Workflow Automation server.

OnCommand Workflow Automation deployment architecture

OnCommand Workflow Automation (WFA) server is installed to orchestrate the workflow operations across several datacenters.

You can centrally manage your automation environment by connecting your WFA server to several Active IQ Unified Manager deployments and VMware vCenters.

The following illustration shows a deployment example:

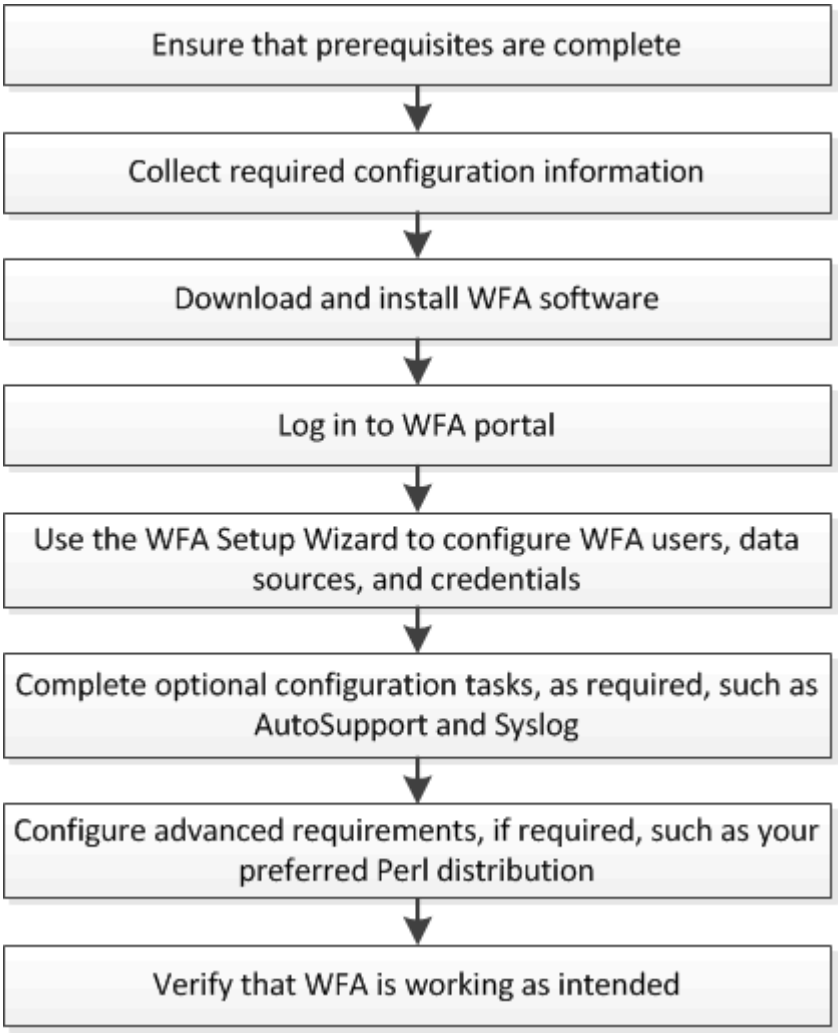


OnCommand Workflow Automation (WFA) deployment

OnCommand Workflow Automation installation and setup overview

Installing OnCommand Workflow Automation (WFA) includes performing tasks such as preparing for the installation, downloading the WFA installer, and running the installer. After the installation is complete, you can configure WFA to meet your requirements.

The following flowchart illustrates the installation and configuration tasks:



Known limitations and enhancements

OnCommand Workflow Automation (WFA) 5.1 includes some limitations and unsupported features that you should be aware of before you install and configure WFA.

- **Creating category names**
  - When a hyphen (-) is used in a category name, it is replaced with a space once the category is saved. For example, if the category name "abc-xyz" is provided, the category name is saved as "abc xyz", with the hyphen removed. To avoid this issue, do not use hyphens in category names.
  - When a colon (:) is used in a category name, the text string before the colon is ignored once the category is saved. For example, if the category name "abc : xyz" is provided, the category name is saved as "xyz", with the "abc" string removed. To avoid this issue, do not use colons in category names.
  - There is no check to prevent two categories having the same name. However, this causes a problem when selecting these categories from the navigation pane. To avoid this issue, make sure that each category name is unique.

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